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SUPREME COURT

Justices endorse immigration agenda

Ruling in Roundup case is a major blow for agricultural states, advocates say

By Christiana Freitag
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The U.S. Supreme Court on Thursday sided with pesticide manufacturer Monsanto in a closely watched Roundup case, ruling that federal law overrides state claims that the company failed to warn consumers about cancer risks associated with its products.

The 7-2 decision in *Monsanto v. Durnell* overturns a Missouri verdict won by St. Louis gardener John Durnell, who argued years of exposure to the herbicide contributed to his non-Hodgkins lymphoma. The court ruled that

states cannot require product warnings that exceed U.S. Environmental Protection Agency regulations. It approved Roundup in 1974 and stated it posed no adverse health effects when used as directed.

However, glyphosate, the active ingredient in Roundup, has been classified as “probably carcinogenic to humans,” since 2015 by the World Health Organization.

The ruling carries significance for agricultural states like Illinois, one of the nation’s largest producers of corn and soybeans and among the heaviest users of

See **ROUNDUP** on Page A5



A demonstrator attends a vigil Feb. 3 for Haitian refugees living legally in the United States in Miami. **LYNNE SLADKY/AP**

INSIDE: Chicago resident in risk of deportation after Supreme Court ruling. **Chicagoland, Page A3**

Two sharply divided decisions let US lift migrant protections, block asylum seekers

By Ann E. Marimow
THE NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — In two sharply divided decisions Thursday, the Supreme Court allowed President Donald Trump’s aggressive crackdown on immigration to move forward, permitting the administration to both expel some migrants from the country and to turn away others at the southern border.

Taken together, the court’s conservative majority signaled deference to the president’s ability to set the nation’s immigration policy, as the justices prepare in the coming days to issue more rulings

that will decide how much power to give Trump across his boundary-pushing agenda.

In one ruling Thursday, the justices allowed the Trump administration to end humanitarian protections that have permitted hundreds of thousands of people from Haiti and Syria to live and work legally in the United States.

Trump has long pushed to terminate the program, known as Temporary Protected Status, as part of his efforts to restrict immigration. The program was created by Congress with bipartisan support in 1990 to provide

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TROY STOLT/FOR THE CHICAGO TRIBUNE

No longer frozen in time

People gather outside the world’s first Dairy Queen on Thursday at 501 N. Chicago St. in Joliet to dedicate part of its restoration. The shop, along historic Route 66, opened in 1940 and is now under the management of the Joliet Area Historical Museum. “You have the meeting of two very iconic things,” said Greg Peerbolte, the museum’s CEO. “You’re talking about one of America’s most recognizable companies, and it is sitting on Route 66.” **Chicagoland, Page A2**

Aldermen rip proposed parking meter buyers’ ICE ties

By Jake Sheridan and A.D. Quig
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayor Brandon Johnson’s administration has repeatedly invoked a non-disclosure agreement to justify not sharing information with the public and aldermen as the City Council vets a planned sale Chicago’s parking meter system.

As Johnson’s top attorneys cited it again Thursday at a council hearing on the proposed deal, the companies on the other side of the confidentiality pact offered to tear it up on the spot.

“We can sign it literally right now, blanket waiver, whatever you want to say,” said James Wyper, managing director at Stonepeak,

the New York investment firm attempting to buy the meters from their current owner, Chicago Parking Meters LLC.

It was just one strange moment of many in the spirited, if not raucous, hearing aimed at vetting the sale of the infamously privatized system.

As aldermen badgered the buyer, seller and Johnson’s top lawyers during the no-vote hearing, some zeroed in on the mayor, accusing his team of being unnecessarily secretive. Others grilled Stonepeak, bashing the firm for its ownership of a company that carries out long-haul deportation flights for the federal government.

But through every tense ques-

See **METERS** on Page A5



A motorist uses an app on her phone to pay for parking on North Wabash Avenue in Chicago on Thursday. Aldermen across the spectrum remain skeptical of a deal that would land the parking meter system a new owner. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/TRIBUNE**

1st felony conviction from Blitz on rocks

Scandal over alleged grand jury misconduct continues to swirl

By Jason Meisner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

One of the only felony convictions secured by federal prosecutors in Operation Midway Blitz now appears to be under threat, as a scandal over alleged grand jury misconduct continues to swirl around the U.S. attorney’s office.

Anthony Gonzalez Alvarez, 27, of Lyons, pleaded guilty in April to a felony charge stemming from a traffic altercation with Border Patrol agents in Brighton Park in October.

His sentencing had been scheduled for July 22. On Thursday, however, prosecutors filed a motion asking for the sentencing to be stayed, as “the parties are in the process of evaluating a potential legal issue” with the charge to which Alvarez pleaded guilty. That charge — misprision of a felony — was filed in a superseding information Alvarez pleaded to, which followed the original indictment.

The motion stated the U.S. attorney’s office “has re-offered” Alvarez a plea agreement that would resolve the case as a misdemeanor. Prosecutors asked U.S. District Judge LaShonda Hunt to schedule a status hearing in late July or early August.

In a statement released Thursday, the U.S. attorney’s office stressed the filing involved a “technical legal issue” with the superseding information filed in April, “not an indictment returned by any grand jury.” The office, which has seen itself facing unprecedented scrutiny after grand jury irregularities, declined to provide details.

Alvarez’s attorney, Rick Meza, had no immediate comment Thursday.

While according to prosecutors, the issue in Alvarez’s case is not directly linked to the grand jury, the session that led to the original indictment has an interesting wrinkle that has resulted in the ongoing review of numerous cases.

Court records show Alvarez was indicted on Oct. 23 by the same grand jury that had also returned an indictment that same day in the “Broadview Six” case, which later collapsed amid allegations of

See **CONVICTION** on Page A4

SPORTS

Historic twin-bill

C Dansby Swanson busted out of his slump Wednesday, slugging a three-run home run and a grand slam in Game 1 of a doubleheader against the Mets, then driving in four runs in Game 2.

ARTS & ENTERTAINMENT

Blend of circus and story

“Water for Elephants” at Chicago’s Nederlander Theatre requires both circus artists and traditional Broadway ensemble members. The fusion of those two demands is its greatest achievement.

NATION & WORLD

Quakes roil Venezuela

Venezuelans searched for survivors beneath collapsed buildings Thursday, and rescue teams raced to northern areas rocked by two powerful earthquakes that officials say killed at least 188. **Page B4**

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